

ScriptLens writer brief — RECLAIMED (story6)

Worked example of the three product tools: orphan scenes, simulate cut, and simulate edit. Numbers below are from running ScriptLens on `scripts/regression testing/story6.fountain` (`analyze_structure + cut/edit impact APIs`).

What ScriptLens checks

Orphan scenes	Which scenes are structurally disconnected?	Scene ids (or none) + short quote
Simulate cut	If we delete scene X, what loses support later?	2–4 cut rows: id → impacted ids + risk
Simulate edit	If we rewrite scene X, which links change?	1–2 edits: what changed + what should break

Structure-only: characters, locations, props, continuity, some story-function intros. Not prose quality, theme, or “is the twist good.”

Scene map (ScriptLens numbering)

scene_001	1	INT. KITCHEN - DAY
scene_002	2	EXT. BACK GARDEN - CONTINUOUS (THROUGH WINDOW)
scene_003	3	INT. KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS
scene_004	4	EXT. STREET / EMMA'S FRONT PORCH - MOMENTS LATER
scene_005	5	INT. EMMA'S LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS
scene_006	6	INT. KITCHEN - HOUR EARLIER (DIFFERENT ANGLE)
scene_007	7	INT. EMMA'S LIVING ROOM - PRESENT
scene_008	8	EXT. BACK GARDEN - LATER (DUSK)

8 scenes, full structure mode. The bare `FLASHBACK:` line is not its own scene — scene 6 is the flashback kitchen; scene 7 returns to Emma’s living room.

Format rule: every scene break must be a real Fountain slugline (`INT.` / `EXT.` / `INT/EXT.` / `I/E.`). Prose without sluglines collapses into one scene and orphan/cut labels become meaningless.

1. Orphan scenes — ScriptLens result

Orphans found: 0 (empty list).

Why that fits this script:

- Jessica / Tom / kitchen / garden / Emma / Gracie recur
- Flashback (scene 6) shares kitchen + Jessica + Tom / bench wound with 1 and 3

- Closing garden (scene 8) pays off Gracie + garden from scene 2

Writer label (clean / Family B)

```
expected_orphans: []
notes: >
  Clean connected thriller short. No hard orphan intended.
  Continuity via Jessica, kitchen/garden, Emma, Gracie.
```

To plant a hard orphan instead: add a scene with no shared named character, no location family, and no tracked CAPS prop with the rest of the script.

2. Simulate cut — ScriptLens result (every scene)

Scene ID	Location	Risk	Impact	Later Scenes
scene_001	Kitchen / death	high	Drops Introduces Jessica; affects 6 later scenes	3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8
scene_002	Garden / Gracie	low	Beats not uniquely required later	(none listed)
scene_003	Kitchen / police	low	Drops Introduces Female Officer	4
scene_004	Porch → Emma	low	Drops Introduces Emma	5
scene_005	Emma's living room	low	Not uniquely required later	(none)
scene_006	Flashback kitchen	low	Not uniquely required later	(none)
scene_007	Living room present	low	Not uniquely required later	(none)
scene_008	Garden dusk / end	none	Terminal; safe structurally	(none)

“Low risk” ≠ “useless scene.” It means later scenes are not uniquely structurally dependent on it. Drama can still break.

Suggested cut labels (pick 2–4, not all eight)

```
expected_simulate_delete:
- scene_id: scene_001
  expect_impacted:
    - scene_003
    - scene_004
    - scene_005
    - scene_006
    - scene_007
    - scene_008
  expect_risk_in: [high, medium]
anchor: >
  Scene 1 introduces Jessica and the kitchen death; later scenes
  depend on her.
```

```

- scene_id: scene_008
  expect_impacted: []
  expect_risk_in: [none, low]
  anchor: >
    Ending garden beat; nothing comes after it.

- scene_id: scene_004
  expect_impacted: [scene_005]
  expect_risk_in: [low, medium]
  anchor: >
    Emma is introduced on the porch; living-room scene needs her.

```

3. Simulate edit — ScriptLens results on story6

Four teaching edits were run through ScriptLens. Only Edit A changed structure.

Edit A — Strip dog/bone plant (scene_002) → structure changes

Intent: remove Gracie burying the bone (plant for the ending).

ScriptLens: risk **low**; **1 link changed** (scene_002 → scene_008): object channel **GRACIE** dropped; location **BACK GARDEN** remains. Orphan count still 0.

```

expected_simulate_edit:
- scene_id: scene_002
  modified_text: |
    EXT. BACK GARDEN - CONTINUOUS (THROUGH WINDOW)

    Outside, the vegetable patch is quiet. Fresh rocket seedlings
    sit undisturbed in the soil.
  expect_edges_changed_min: 1
  expect_edges_removed_min: 0
  expect_risk_in: [low, medium]
  anchor: >
    Removing Gracie weakens the object link to the dusk garden payoff.

```

Edit B — Strip gold locket (scene_003) → no dependency change

Dramatic detail; not treated as a tracked continuity prop here. **ScriptLens:** no story dependencies changed.

Edit C — Strip shoelace beat (scene_006) → no dependency change

Clever crime beat, but not a recurring tracked prop across scenes. **ScriptLens:** no dependency change.

Edit D — Cosmetic “Tea” → “Coffee” (scene_005) → no-op

ScriptLens: no dependency change. Good control edit.

```

- scene_id: scene_005
  modified_text: |
    (same scene; Emma says "Coffee." instead of "Tea.")
  expect_edges_changed_min: 0
  expect_edges_removed_min: 0
  expect_risk_in: [none, low]
  anchor: >
    Cosmetic word swap only; no continuity referent removed.

```

Writer tip: not every object is structural. Prefer CAPS plants that recur (GRACIE, BRASS KEY, STEEL BRIEFCASE).

4. Variation menu (practice on clones of this script)

B	Clean	Keep as-is	<code>expected_orphans: []</code>
H1	Hard orphan	Insert unrelated diner + new cast	that scene in orphans
F1	Chekhov reinforce	CAPS prop in scene 1, reuse in 8	still <code>[]</code> orphans
F4	Imagined insert	(IMAGINED) / DREAM slugline	exempt / not orphan
C1	Cut intro	Label cut of <code>scene_001</code>	high impact set
C2	Cut ending	Label cut of <code>scene_008</code>	empty impact
C4	Edit plant	Strip Gracie from scene 2	edges changed ≥ 1
C6	Edit no-op	Tea→Coffee in scene 5	edges changed = 0

5. What to submit per script

1. Scene count you believe is correct
2. Orphans: list or `none`, each with one evidence quote
3. Cuts: max 2–4 rows (scene → impacted → risk)
4. Edits: max 1–2 rows (what changed → what should break / not break)

Label **story structure intent + quotes**. Do not invent engine output. ScriptLens is an advisory cross-check later — not the definition of gold.

Bottom line for story6

- **Orphans:** none — clean connected example
- **Simulate cut:** scene 1 is high-risk; scene 8 is safe; 3 and 4 matter as intros
- **Simulate edit:** stripping **Gracie** from the garden plant is the clear structural edit; locket / shoelace / tea→coffee are non-structural here

Source file: `scripts/regression_testing/story6.fountain`